whether Musharraf's early efforts had staying power.[11] Meanwhile, both sides maintained troop deployments along the border.

US officials understood that it would take time for Musharraf to fulfill his promises vis-à-vis decreasing support for militancy in Kashmir.[12] However, an incremental approach hinged upon Pakistan's actual willingness to make forward progress. Instead, those groups that were banned after the Parliament attack had quickly reinvented themselves under new names. The ISI had directed Lashkar and other outfits on the steps they should take in order to protect their assets. It also encouraged attacks in Indian-administered Kashmir in order to 'resuscitate morale among the jihadi groups and to show that the army had not abandoned them.'[13] Indian officials asserted that the number of militants infiltrating across the LoC in March and April was roughly the same as in the previous two years. According to a *New York Times* report filed on 13 May, Indian officials also alleged that approximately 2,000 militants remained spread out along the Pakistani side of the LoC. Despite the prospect of a rise in infiltration, the Indian defense minister said at the time that India did not foresee taking military action in the near-term.[14]

A day after that report was filed, Lashkar launched an attack against a passenger bus and an Indian army barracks in the town of Kaluchak, reigniting the crisis. The barracks housed not only Indian military personnel, but also their families. Many of those killed were wives and children of Indian soldiers.[15] New Delhi responded by expelling Pakistan's ambassador and moving its forces to forward positions. Amidst intense exchanges of fire across the LoC, the two countries also redeployed fighter aircraft and began making public statements about their nuclear readiness. Once again the US sought to mediate a solution. Deputy Secretary of State Armitage met President Musharraf in Pakistan in early June, and the latter insisted that 'nothing is happening' along the Line of Control. He had used this language, artfully articulated in the present tense, before and Armitage sought a guarantee that cross-LoC activity would not resume once the crisis had cleared. He secured a pledge from President Musharraf to halt cross-LoC infiltration permanently and, after privately apprising Indian officials of this promise, announced it publicly while in India. It is questionable whether American or Indian officials believed Musharraf would make good